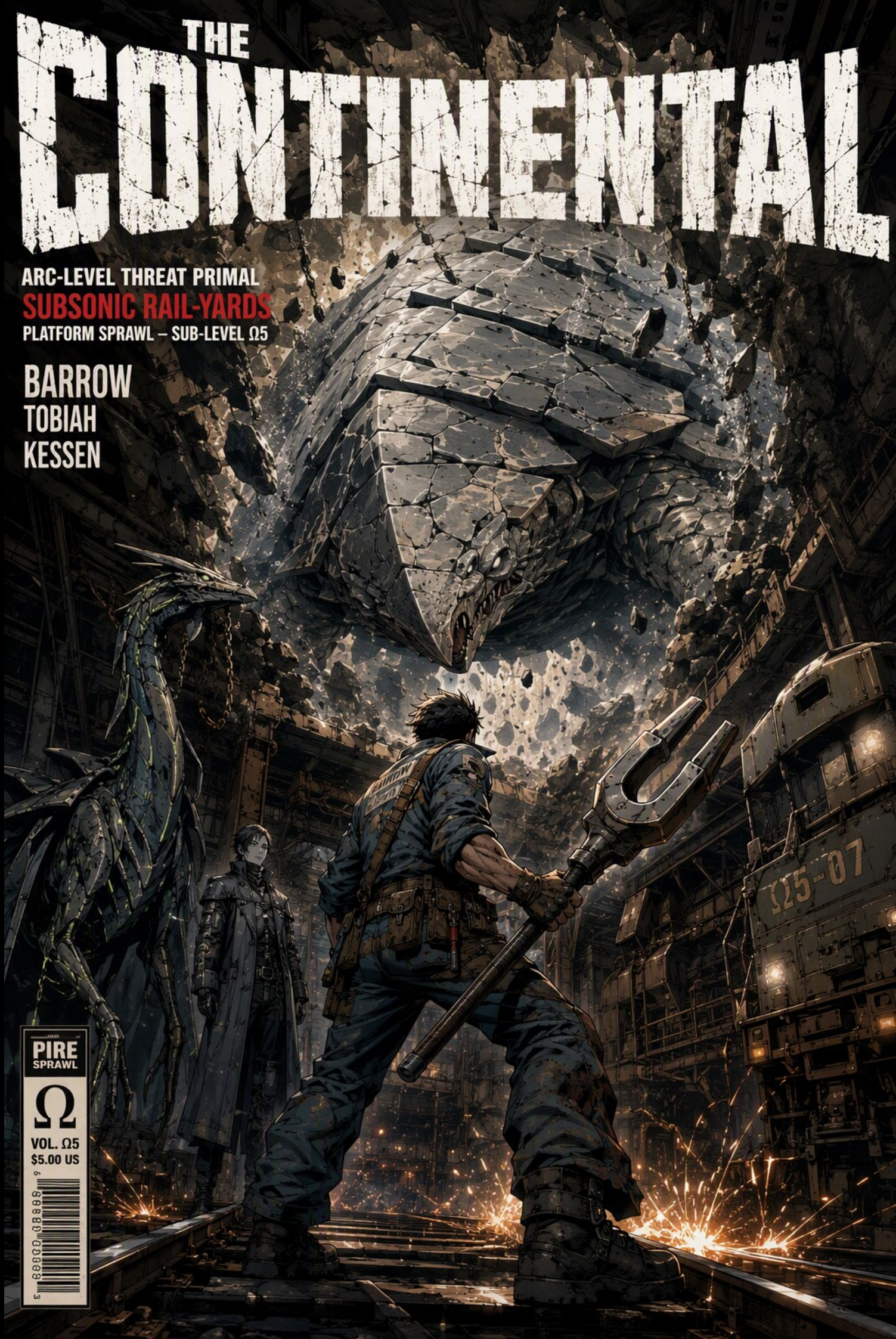


THE CONTINENTAL

ARC-LEVEL THREAT PRIMAL
SUBSONIC RAIL-YARDS
PLATFORM SPRAWL — SUB-LEVEL Ω5

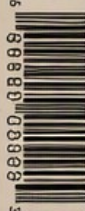
BARROW
TOBIAH
KESSEN



PIRE
SPRAWL

Ω

VOL. Ω5
\$5.00 US



THE SUBSONIC RAIL-YARDS

MORNING SHIFT

WHERE ALL THE
LINES MEET,
AND NOBODY'S
IN A HURRY.

HOT
JAVA. DON'T
SCREW UP.

PURRRR
BRRRRP

TRACK 7
SERVICE ABOVE
SELF

MANTIS
BITE
TOOLS

朝ごはん

NOM
NOM!

線路包子
RAIL-YARD DUMPLINGS

YOU
SLEPT AT
ALL?

TRAIN DON'T
CARE. WE
KEEP IT
MOVIN'.

KCHNK
KCHNK
KCHNK

'PRECIMATE
YA.

YEAH,
YEAH.

TODAY'S SPECIAL

- PORK & SCALLION
- SPICE-GINGER
- VEG & FUNGUS

EXTRA SAUCE
IF YOU SMILE!



BISCUIT



GOOD BOY
BEST BOY!

TO: PELL
THANKS FER
KEEPIN' US FED.
-NIGHT CREW

BARROW OWES YOU
3 BOLTS (AGAIN)
-DON'T TELL HIM.



GOOD FOOD.
GOOD FOLKS.
THAT'S HOW
THE YARDS
RUN RIGHT.



SUBSONIC
RAIL-YARDS.

MORNING ROUTINE.
STEAM. NOODLES.
EVERYTHING IN ITS
RIGHT PLACE.

THEN—

KRRR-RUMMBLE!!

THE GROUND
SHUDDERS.

ROUTINE
DISAGREES.

TOBIAH
DOES NOT RUSH.

HE CALCULATES.

KESSEN
MOVES AS
ONE.

BISCUIT
PANIC-INFLATES.

AS INTENDED.

THE
IRON-LOUSE

ROLLS
WITH IT.

**CLATTER-
BOWL!!**

YOU
ALRIGHT,
BISCUIT?

BWEEEP!

BWEE...

STRIKE!

CHAOS IS
INEVITABLE.

ATTENTION IS
A CHOICE.

PRECISION IS
OUR ANSWER.

RAIL-YARDS,
LEVEL HATE-DELTA.
BETWEEN TWO MASSIVE
MAG-LEV TRAIN CARS.
COUPLING PIN:
SEIZED.



MARROW-TUSK.
PRIMAL. TERRITORIAL.
DECEPTIVELY FAST.
CURRENTLY:
ENTHUSIASTIC.

A CALLING
INITIATES.

SHOCK-ABSORPTION
SYNC: OPEN.
STRENGTH
INCOMING.

OH, HELL
YEAH.

LET'S
GOOO!



COUPLING-MAIL:

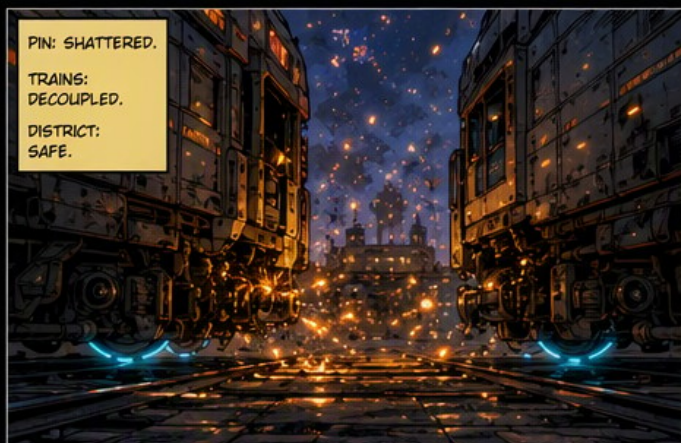
PRIGE-MANTIS
CLAW FORGED
TO HUMAN STEEL.

UNBALANCED.
VIBRATES.
WRIST-SHATTERING.
TRAIN-SETTING.

TODAY:
TRAIN-FREED.



PIN: SHATTERED.
TRAINS:
DECOUPLED.
DISTRICT:
SAFE.



★ CLANG! ★



GOOD WORK.
GOOD CREW.
GOOD DAY.



KEEP THE TRAINS MOVING.
KEEP THE DISTRICT ALIVE.



THE RAIL-YARDS.
DAWN.

THE RAIL-YARDS
WILL NEVER
FORGET THIS
DAY!

CLAP!
CLAP!

BARROW!!!
YOU SAVED
THE CONTINENT!!!

THAT'S OUR
HAMMERER!!

THREE CHEERS
FOR BARROW!!

MIZUKI
GLIDER MECHANIC
17 YEARS OLD

HOSHI
STRATO-LYNX
COMPANION

DEEP BENEATH THE CONTINENT...
THE CONTINENTAL.
PRIMAL OF SEISMIC SENSE.
BLIND.
OLDER THAN MOUNTAINS.
LARGER THAN REASON.

IT DOES NOT SEE.
IT LISTENS.
TO THE LANGUAGE OF
STONE.
TO THE RHYTHM OF
THE WORLD.

BARROW'S HAMMER STRIKE
SENDS AN ACOUSTIC WAVE
THROUGH THE BEDROCK.
A SINGLE, PERFECT TONE.

THE CONTINENTAL
FEELS IT.
IT TURNS.
IT UNDERSTANDS.
IT LETS THE CITY LIVE.

...THE TONE
IS SMALL.
HARMLESS.

... THE
RHYTHM IS
HUMAN.
NOT A
THREAT.

...THE CITY
ABOVE...
IS
NOT PREY.

...PEACE.
FOR NOW.
AS LONG AS
THE RHYTHM
HOLDS.

THE FROST-LOCK BASIN.
AGRICULTURAL HEARTLAND
OF THE SOUTHERN RIM.

SURROUNDED. ISOLATED.
AND CURRENTLY SUCKED
INTO A CATEGORY-5
VACUUM STORM.



I DON'T CARE WHO
SENT YOU! TURN
AROUND!
THE FLOODGATES
STAY SHUT!
UNDERSTAND!?
SHUT!

I-I JUST NEED
TO DELIVER THIS
WARNING BEACON!
THE UPPER RIM--
"HUFF"--THEY'RE
COLLAPSING THE
NORTH SPUR! WE'RE
ALL GONNA--



KARRIS
DAM WARDEN.
LOCAL LAW.
LOCAL WATER.
LOCAL DECISIONS.

I DON'T CARE
WHAT THE UPPER
RIM THINKS IS
"IMPORTANT!"

NOT THEIR
WATER!

NOT THEIR
FARMS!

NOT THEIR
CHOICE!

HMPH!

I'M
JUST A
COURIER...

CAN'T WE
TALK
ABOUT
THIS...?

URGH...



TALK!?
YOU WANT
TO TALK!?

I'LL SHOW YOU
TALKING!

I'LL SHOW YOU
"UPPER RIM!"

I SWEAR ON
MY SNOWBOOTS
I WILL SHOOT
YOU SO FULL OF
ICE YOU'LL RATTLE
LIKE A MARACA!



...FINE.
SHOOT ME.
THEN WATCH
THE RESERVOIR
DRAIN WHEN THE
WHOLE RIDGE
COMES DOWN.

THEN I'LL
SHOOT THE
RIDGE TOO!
I'M VERY GOOD
AT SHOOTING
THINGS!



FROST-LOCK BASIN - HOLD THE LINE.

FROST-LOCK BASIN.
THE BLACK ICE CLIFFS.

CAN'T
HOLD...
SLIPPIN'...

AAAH!

SHKREEEE—

AGAIN...

...!

A RIDGE-MANTIS.
A PRIMAL.

NOT A THREAT.
A CHOICE.

IT OFFERS
NOT COMMAND...
BUT TRUST.

THANK
YOU.

THE CALLING
IS ANSWERED.

TOGETHER,
WE RISE.

THIS IS
THE CALLING.
THIS IS
THE WAY.

THE SUMMIT.
FROST-LOCK BASIN.

EMERGENCY BEACON:
ACTIVE.

CINDER-MOTH
SWARM INBOUND.

DISTANCE:
1.7 KLICKS.

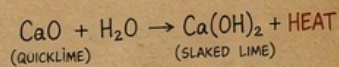
WIND:
NORTH BY
NORTHEAST.



HEAT.
REACTION.
SCALE.
...

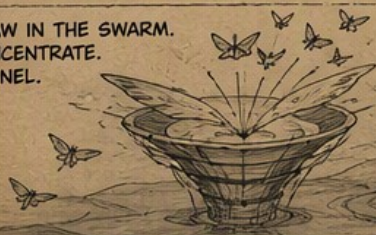
THE ALKALI SALT FLATS.
FLOOD + EXOTHERMIC REACTION.
SUSTAINED HEAT.

WATER IN.
BRINE OUT. — HEAT UP.



INDUSTRIAL SCALE.
DAYS OF COMBUSTION.

DRAW IN THE SWARM.
CONCENTRATE.
FUNNEL.



THERMAL PILLAR.
UPDRAFT.
DISPERSE.
SPARE THE BASIN.



IF WE
FLOOD THE
FLATS...

WE MAKE
THE HEAT THEY
CAN'T IGNORE.

I'M A COOK.

I KNOW HOW
TO FEED A FIRE.

THIS TIME...
WE FEED THEIR
WORLD.

FROST-LOCK BASIN.
GATE SEVENTEEN.

THE WIND
MAKES WEAPONS
OF WATER.

YOU'LL FREEZE
US ALL! STOP!

WARDEN!
HELP--!

AND THESE HANDS
MAKE ENEMIES
OF NEIGHBORS.

TOBIAH!
THIS ISN'T
YOUR FIGHT!

BUT IF WE DO NOTHING,
THE CONTINENT DROWNS.

THEN LET US
SHOULDER WHAT
YOU CANNOT.

COMPASSION IS A LUXURY
THE ICE DOES NOT ALLOW.

UNNGH--!

WE OPEN
THE GATES.

SO OTHERS
MIGHT LIVE.

FROST-LOCK BASIN.
DEPTH: 2,800 METERS.
AIR TEMP: -147°C.
WIND: VARIABLE.

NOTES:
CINDER-MOTH MIGRATION
ATTRACTED TO CHEM-HEAT
BLOOM. DENSITY: EXTREME.

LOOKS LIKE
TONIGHT'S MEAL
DECIDED TO
FOLLOW US.

STRATO-LYNX: HOSHI.
THERMAL OUTPUT: MAX.
UPDRAFT VECTOR: 67° UP.
SWARM RESPONSE: POSITIVE.

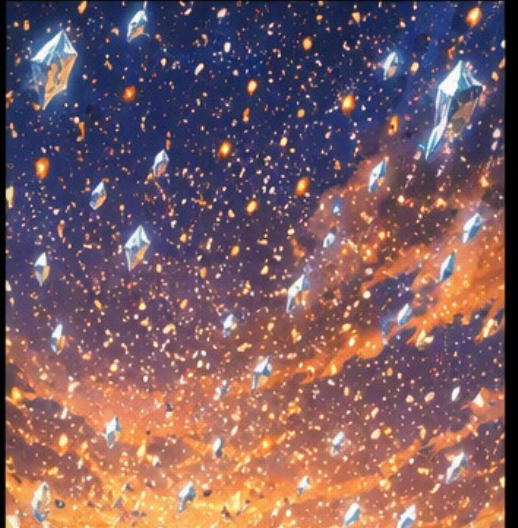
KITE-HERDING PATTERN:
SPIRAL CLIMB.
OBJECTIVE:
KEEP THEM TOGETHER.
KEEP THEM HUNGRY.
KEEP THEM MOVING.

CINDER-MOTHS.
LUNA-SCALE VARIANT.
BIOLUMINESCENT DUST.
HIGHLY FLAMMABLE.
EXTREMELY HUNGRY.

THEY COME
FOR THE HEAT.
THEY STAY FOR
THE HUNT.

WE DON'T FIGHT
THE STORM.
WE FLY IT.

LET'S DANCE,
STAR BOY.



THE
STORM
BREAKS.

THE
CIRCLE
OPENS.

THE CONTINENTAL.

AN ARC-LEVEL THREAT
PRIMAL TECTONIC
IN SCALE.

BLIND.

IT DOES NOT SEE.
IT FEELS.

IT RIDES THE SONG
OF THE PLANET.



TODAY,
IT RETURNS.
NOT AS AN ENEMY.
BUT AS THE
CONTINENT
REMEMBERING
ITS OCEAN.



...WORTH
THE WAIT.



HMPH.

THE OCEAN
IS STILL FAR
TOO LOUD.

AND YOU
STILL SMELL
LIKE RUST.



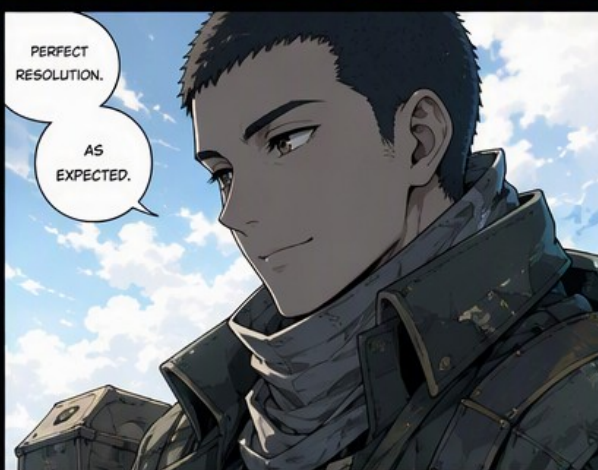
YEAH,
YEAH.

SAVE THE
COMPLIMENTS.

LET'S
GET
HOME.



THE CONTINENTAL
HAS SETTLED.



BACK IN THE
SUBSONIC RAIL-YARDS.



YEAH, YEAH...
I KNOW.

PRRRRRRRR
PRRRRRRR



YOU LOT
DON'T MAKE
IT EASY.

BUT...
YOU'RE
ALRIGHT.



GOOD
BEAST.

~7...



PRRRRRRRRR



HEH.

UGLIEST CORNER
OF THE CITY.

WOULDN'T
TRADE IT FOR
ANYWHERE
ELSE.



BARROW
SUBSONIC TRANSIT
MAINTENANCE DIV.
77TH DISTRICT.



77TH DISTRICT
KEEP IT MOVING.

SUBSONIC RAIL-YARDS
PLATFORM 7B

TONIGHT,
WE EAT LIKE
WE SURVIVED.

TO ANOTHER
DAY ABOVE
THE ABYSS!
— THE YARD

PELL
COOK. FIXER.
PROBLEM SOLVER.
QUIET HERO.

MORE
BROTH?

YOU BET.

MRRMMF!
(MORE!
MORE!)

BISCUIT
PRIMAL. PANIC-FLUFFER.
PROFESSIONAL WORRIER.
FOOD CRITIC.

HM.
ACCEPTABLE.

KESSEN
RIDGE-MANTIS.
SCOUT. SENTINEL.
HIGHLY JUDGMENTAL.

TO FAMILY!

TO SURVIVAL!

TO TOMORROW!

CHEERS!

AH—
YOU DON'T
HAVE TO—

PELL! PELL!
BEST COOK ON
THE YARD!

IF IT AIN'T
PELL, WE
RIOT!

Y-Y'ALL
GONNA MAKE
ME PUT THIS
LADLE DOWN.

MAYBE WE
AIN'T BLOOD.
MAYBE WE
AIN'T SUPPOSED
TO LAST.

BUT RIGHT HERE,
RIGHT NOW—
WE'RE ENOUGH.
THAT'S PLENTY.

THE WORLD
DIDN'T END.

IT JUST
KEPT GOING.

QUIETER
NOW.

KINDER,
MAYBE.

THERE.
THAT'S IT.

A NEW
ISLAND.

NO ONE
KNEW ABOUT
YESTERDAY.

UNNAMED.
UNCLAIMED.

THAT'S HOW
IT SHOULD
BE.

NEW DAWN.

A PLACE
TO BREATHE.

A PLACE TO
CHOOSE YOUR
OWN SKY.

THEY'LL
BUILD.

IN THEIR
OWN TIME.

NOT BY HEROES.

NOT BY DESTINY.

BY PEOPLE WHO
REFUSED TO GIVE UP.

AND THE PRIMALS
WHO STAYED.

THAT'S HOW
WE WON.

THE END.